

# FreePremium — Production Deploy Guide

**Stack:** GitHub → Vercel (Next.js app) → Neon *or* Supabase (free Postgres) → Cloudflare (domain DNS)

**Audience:** Client / operator — follow every step in order. No coding experience required beyond copy/paste.

**Outcome:** Live site at `https://yourdomain.com` with admin panel, database, HTTPS, and automatic deploys from GitHub.

Adult site · 18+ · Keep admin secrets private

**Important:** FreePremium is one full-stack Next.js app. Do **not** put “frontend on Netlify” and “backend elsewhere.” Use **Vercel for the whole app** and **Postgres** (Neon or Supabase) for the database. SQLite files do not work on Vercel’s serverless filesystem.

## 0. What you will create

| Piece                 | Service                 | Cost (typical)      | Job                                 |
|-----------------------|-------------------------|---------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Source code           | GitHub                  | Free                | Store code + trigger auto-deploy    |
| Website / API / Admin | Vercel                  | Free Hobby tier*    | Runs Next.js in production          |
| Database              | Neon <i>or</i> Supabase | Free Postgres tier* | Stores videos, categories, settings |
| Domain DNS + HTTPS    | Cloudflare              | Free plan           | Points domain to Vercel, SSL        |

\* Free tiers have limits (sleep / compute). Fine for launch and moderate traffic; upgrade later if needed. Adult content is allowed on these stacks when you follow each provider’s ToS — always review current policies.

**Time estimate:** 45–90 minutes the first time if accounts already exist.

**You need:** a computer, email, domain name, GitHub access to the FreePremium repo (or a zip from your developer), and a password manager recommended.

## 1. Accounts to create (do this first)

1. **GitHub** — `https://github.com/signup`
2. **Vercel** — `https://vercel.com/signup` (sign up with GitHub)
3. **Neon** — `https://neon.tech` *or* **Supabase** — `https://supabase.com` (pick one database)
4. **Cloudflare** — `https://dash.cloudflare.com/sign-up`

Use a strong unique password for admin later. Never reuse your GitHub password as `ADMIN_PASSWORD`.

## 2. Get the code onto GitHub

Your developer should already have FreePremium in a Git repository. Choose **A** or **B**.

### Option A — Developer already pushed the repo

1. Open GitHub → find the FreePremium repository.
2. Confirm you are a collaborator / owner.
3. Copy the repo URL, e.g. `https://github.com/YOUR_USER/freepremium`.

### Option B — Create a new GitHub repo and upload

1. GitHub → **New repository**.
2. Name: `freepremium` (or your brand name).
3. Visibility: **Private** recommended (contains your business app).
4. Do **not** add a README if the project already has files.
5. Ask your developer to push the code, **or** use GitHub Desktop:
  - Install GitHub Desktop → File → Add Local Repository → choose the FreePremium folder.
  - Publish repository to your GitHub account.

**Never upload** the real `.env` file to GitHub. Only `.env.example` is safe. Secrets go into Vercel Environment Variables (Section 5).

## 3. Create the free Postgres database

Choose **either Neon or Supabase** — not both for the same site.

### 3A. Neon (recommended for Vercel)

1. Go to `https://console.neon.tech` → Sign up / Log in.
2. Click **Create project**.
3. Name: `freepremium`. Region: pick closest to your audience (e.g. US East for USA traffic).
4. Create project → open the project dashboard.
5. Click **Connect** (or Connection details).
6. Copy **two** connection strings:
  - **Pooled** connection → this becomes `DATABASE_URL` (often contains `-pooler` in the host).
  - **Direct** connection → this becomes `DIRECT_URL` (no pooler).
7. Both should look like:  
`postgresql://USER:PASSWORD@HOST/neondb?sslmode=require`

Keep both strings in a password manager. You will paste them into Vercel soon.

### 3B. Supabase (alternative)

1. Go to `https://supabase.com/dashboard` → New project.
2. Set a strong database password (save it).
3. Region: choose closest to users.
4. Project Settings → **Database** → Connection string.
5. Copy:
  - **URI (Transaction pooler / Mode: Transaction)** → `DATABASE_URL`
  - **URI (Session / Direct)** → `DIRECT_URL`
6. Replace `[YOUR-PASSWORD]` with the real DB password if the UI shows a placeholder.
7. Ensure strings include SSL (Supabase usually adds this automatically).

## 4. Create secrets you will need

Generate these on your computer before opening Vercel.

### 4.1 Session secret

On Mac / Linux / Git Bash / Windows (PowerShell with OpenSSL), run:

```
openssl rand -base64 48
```

Copy the entire output. That is `SESSION_SECRET` (must be 32+ characters).

If OpenSSL is missing on Windows, use any long random string (64+ random characters) from a password manager.

### 4.2 Admin login

| Variable                    | Example rules                                   |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| <code>ADMIN_USERNAME</code> | Your private username (not "admin" if possible) |
| <code>ADMIN_PASSWORD</code> | Minimum <b>10 characters</b> , long & unique    |

### 4.3 Public site URL

Decide your final domain now, e.g. `https://freepremium.com` or `https://www.freepremium.com`.

Use the **exact** URL (with `https://`, no trailing slash) as `NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL`.

You can temporarily use the Vercel URL first (e.g. `https://freepremium.vercel.app`), then change to the real domain after Cloudflare is set — then redeploy.

## 5. Switch the database to PostgreSQL (required before Vercel)

The developer copy may ship with **SQLite** for local testing. Vercel needs **Postgres**.

1. Open `prisma/schema.prisma`.
2. Find `provider = "sqlite"` and change it to `provider = "postgresql"`.
3. Optional but recommended for Neon — under `url = env("DATABASE_URL")` add:  
`directUrl = env("DIRECT_URL")`
4. Commit and push this change to GitHub (or ask your developer to do it once).
5. Use the Neon/Supabase URLs from Section 3 as `DATABASE_URL` / `DIRECT_URL` in Vercel.

## 6. Deploy on Vercel

1. Open `https://vercel.com/dashboard` → **Add New...** → **Project**.
2. Import the GitHub `freepremium` repository (authorize GitHub if asked).
3. Framework Preset should detect **Next.js**. Leave Root Directory empty (repo root).
4. **Build Command** (confirm): `prisma generate && prisma db push && next build`  
(This is already set in `package.json` — Vercel uses `npm run build`.)
5. **Output:** leave default (Next.js).
6. **Install Command:** `npm install` (default).
7. Before clicking Deploy, open **Environment Variables** and add all of the following for **Production** (also add to Preview if you want preview links to work):

| Name                              | Value                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>DATABASE_URL</code>         | Neon/Supabase <b>pooled</b> Postgres URI                                               |
| <code>DIRECT_URL</code>           | Neon/Supabase <b>direct</b> Postgres URI                                               |
| <code>NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL</code> | <code>https://yourdomain.com</code> (or temporary <code>https://...vercel.app</code> ) |
| <code>ADMIN_USERNAME</code>       | your admin username                                                                    |
| <code>ADMIN_PASSWORD</code>       | your long password (10+ chars)                                                         |
| <code>SESSION_SECRET</code>       | openssl random string (32+ chars)                                                      |

Optional later: `EMBED_ALLOWED_HOSTS` , `EMBED_ALLOW_ANY` — only if your developer instructed you.

8. Click **Deploy**.
9. Wait 2–5 minutes. First deploy creates database tables via `prisma db push`.
10. If it succeeds, open the `*.vercel.app` URL and confirm the homepage loads.

11. Open `https://YOUR-DEPLOY.vercel.app/admin/login` and sign in with `ADMIN_USERNAME` / `ADMIN_PASSWORD`.

## If the deploy fails

- **Prisma / DATABASE\_URL errors** → check both URLs, password encoding, `sslmode=require`, and that `DIRECT_URL` is set.
- **SESSION\_SECRET / ADMIN\_PASSWORD errors** → production refuses weak/missing secrets. Lengthen them and redeploy.
- **Build timeout** → retry once; free tiers can be slow on first build.
- Open Vercel → Project → Deployments → failed deploy → **Building** logs → copy the red error to your developer if stuck.

## 7. Connect your domain with Cloudflare

This makes `https://yourdomain.com` open your Vercel site with free SSL.

### 7.1 Add site to Cloudflare

1. Buy/own a domain (Namecheap, GoDaddy, Google Domains/Squarespace, etc.).
2. Cloudflare Dashboard → **Add a site** → enter `yourdomain.com`.
3. Choose the **Free** plan → Continue.
4. Cloudflare scans existing DNS records → Continue.
5. Cloudflare shows two nameservers, e.g.:

```
ada.ns.cloudflare.com
bob.ns.cloudflare.com
```

6. At your domain registrar, replace the domain's nameservers with Cloudflare's two nameservers → Save.
7. Wait until Cloudflare shows the zone as **Active** (can take 5 minutes to 24 hours; often under 1 hour).

### 7.2 Add domain in Vercel

1. Vercel → your project → **Settings** → **Domains**.
2. Add `yourdomain.com` and (recommended) `www.yourdomain.com`.
3. Vercel shows the DNS records it needs (usually an A record for apex and CNAME for www).

### 7.3 Create DNS records in Cloudflare

Typical Vercel setup (confirm values shown in your Vercel Domains page — they can change):

| Type | Name | Content / Target | Proxy status |
|------|------|------------------|--------------|
|------|------|------------------|--------------|

|       |     |                                                           |                                             |
|-------|-----|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| A     | @   | 76.76.21.21 (Vercel's apex IP — use what Vercel displays) | DNS only (grey cloud) or Proxied — see note |
| CNAME | www | cname.vercel-dns.com (or the exact target Vercel shows)   | DNS only (grey cloud) recommended first     |

**Proxy tip:** For the first connection, set Cloudflare records to **DNS only** (grey cloud). After Vercel marks the domain as Valid / SSL ready, you may turn on Proxied (orange cloud) if you want Cloudflare CDN/WAF. If SSL loops happen, keep DNS only or set SSL/TLS mode to **Full** (not Flexible).

## 7.4 Cloudflare SSL/TLS settings

1. Cloudflare → your domain → **SSL/TLS**.
2. Set encryption mode to **Full** (recommended) or **Full (strict)** once Vercel cert is active.
3. Do **not** use **Flexible** (causes redirect loops with Vercel).

## 7.5 Update site URL env and redeploy

1. Vercel → Project → Settings → Environment Variables.
2. Edit `NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL` to `https://yourdomain.com` (no trailing slash).
3. Deployments → ... on latest → **Redeploy** (required so the new URL is baked into the build).

## 7.6 Verify

- ☐ `https://yourdomain.com` loads the site
- ☐ `https://www.yourdomain.com` redirects or loads correctly
- ☐ Padlock / HTTPS works
- ☐ `https://yourdomain.com/admin/login` accepts your admin password
- ☐ `https://yourdomain.com/sitemap.xml` opens XML
- ☐ `https://yourdomain.com/robots.txt` opens text

## 8. First-time site setup (after go-live)

1. Login: `https://yourdomain.com/admin/login`
2. **Admin** → **Settings**
  - Site SEO Title / Description / Keywords
  - Google Search Console verification code
  - Theme
  - Ad HTML slots (ExoClick / TrafficStars / etc.) — only paste trusted codes
  - Turn **Ad preview mode OFF** for real ads
3. **Admin** → **Categories / Performers / Videos** — add or import content (CSV Maker supported).

#### 4. Google Search Console

- Add property for `https://yourdomain.com`
- Verify with the meta tag code from Settings
- Sitemaps → submit:
  - `https://yourdomain.com/sitemap.xml`
  - `https://yourdomain.com/sitemap-videos.xml`

## 9. How updates work forever (no manual server)

1. Developer pushes code to GitHub `main / master`.
2. Vercel auto-builds and deploys.
3. Database schema updates run during build via `prisma db push`.
4. Your content (videos, settings) stays in Neon/Supabase — not wiped by deploys.

You do **not** need to SSH into a server for normal updates.

## 10. Environment variables cheat sheet (copy into Vercel)

```
DATABASE_URL=postgresql://...pooled...sslmode=require
DIRECT_URL=postgresql://...direct...sslmode=require
NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL=https://yourdomain.com
ADMIN_USERNAME=.....
ADMIN_PASSWORD=.....
SESSION_SECRET=.....
```

## 11. Security rules (read once)

- Never post admin passwords in Discord/email screenshots.
- Never commit `.env` to GitHub.
- Only paste ad scripts from networks you trust (they run in visitors' browsers).
- Keep the site 18+ compliant (age gate is built-in).
- Rotate `ADMIN_PASSWORD` + `SESSION_SECRET` if they leak → update Vercel env → Redeploy.
- Cloudflare email routing / WAF optional later for protection.

## 12. Backups

- **Neon:** Project → Backups / history (plan-dependent). Export SQL periodically for critical data.
- **Supabase:** Database → Backups (plan-dependent). Use dashboard SQL export for snapshots.
- Export important CSV of videos from Admin if you keep a manual inventory.

## 13. Common problems & fixes

| Problem                    | Fix                                                                              |
|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Domain not resolving       | Wait for nameserver activation; check Cloudflare DNS matches Vercel instructions |
| SSL / redirect loop        | Cloudflare SSL = Full (not Flexible); try DNS only (grey cloud)                  |
| Admin login fails          | Check Vercel env vars; password min 10 chars; redeploy after changes             |
| Empty site / no tables     | Confirm build log shows prisma db push success; check DATABASE_URL               |
| Wrong canonical URLs / SEO | Set NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL to real https domain + Redeploy                         |
| Images/embeds blocked      | Ask developer about EMBED_ALLOWED_HOSTS for new hosts                            |
| Free DB "paused"           | Neon free projects may sleep — first request wakes them (few seconds)            |

## 14. Go-live checklist

- ☐ Code is on GitHub (private recommended)
- ☐ Neon or Supabase project created; pooled + direct URLs saved
- ☐ prisma/schema.prisma provider set to postgresql and pushed to GitHub
- ☐ Vercel project imported from GitHub
- ☐ All 6 env vars set on Vercel Production
- ☐ First deploy succeeded (green)
- ☐ Admin login works on vercel.app
- ☐ Domain added in Vercel
- ☐ Cloudflare nameservers active at registrar
- ☐ A / CNAME records correct
- ☐ SSL/TLS = Full
- ☐ NEXT\_PUBLIC\_SITE\_URL updated + redeployed
- ☐ Homepage + /admin work on custom domain
- ☐ SEO settings filled
- ☐ Sitemaps submitted to Google Search Console
- ☐ Ad preview mode off; real ads pasted
- ☐ Secrets stored offline / password manager



## 15. Architecture (simple picture)

```
Visitor → Cloudflare DNS (yourdomain.com)
        → Vercel (Next.js: public site + /api + /admin)
        → Neon or Supabase Postgres (data)
```

## 16. Who to contact for what

| Issue                      | Who                                     |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| DNS / domain not pointing  | Cloudflare docs + this guide §6         |
| Deploy build failed        | Send Vercel build log to your developer |
| Content / ads / SEO text   | You (Admin panel)                       |
| New features / bugs in app | Your developer                          |

### FreePremium — Production Deploy Guide

Stack: GitHub + Vercel + Neon/Supabase Postgres + Cloudflare

This document is written so a non-developer can launch production without a separate consulting call for basic hosting.

File: `docs/FreePremium-Production-Deploy-Guide.pdf` · Companion feature list: `docs/FreePremium-Client-Feature-Guide.pdf`